

CST309 Final Video Script Outline

(Draft for Sept 1 Meeting)

1. Introduction (Tahsin, ~4 min)

- Define cosmopolitan/global citizenship: primary allegiance to "the community of human beings in the entire world," not the nation (Nussbaum, 1994)
- Historical arc: 1947 partition brings Urdu speakers to East Bengal as Pakistani citizens, 1971 Liberation War brands the community with the "collaborator" label, the 1972 Citizenship Order denies Bangladeshi citizenship to roughly 900,000 Urdu speakers who had applied for repatriation to Pakistan, Pakistan never took them back, UNHCR refused refugee status because no border was crossed, decades of confinement in camps follow, the 2003 and 2008 High Court rulings restore citizenship
- Anderson's imagined communities: Bengali nationalism needed a non-Bengali "other" to define itself against, explaining exclusion despite physical presence since 1947/1971
- Linklater's defense of cosmopolitan citizenship against the Walzer-style objection that citizenship only means something inside a bounded nation-state: useful setup for the whole video's argument, since the Bihari case shows the reverse problem, formal national citizenship without functioning inclusion
- Closing pivot line for handoff: legal citizenship was won in 2008, citizenship as lived, everyday practice is a separate, still-open question
- Citations: Nussbaum (1994); Anderson (1983); Linklater (2002); Siddiqi (2013, pp. 150, 164, 166)

2. Community understanding (Arnab, ~5 min)

- Scale: roughly 300,000 Biharis still live across about 70 camps built as "temporary" settlements more than 50 years ago (Minority Rights Group International, 2018)
- Firsthand account (Arnab grew up in Saidpur): one room per family, one shared water point for many households, open drains running past doors
- Documentation-in-practice gap: a resident can hold a valid NID and still have a passport application rejected because the office won't accept a camp address as a permanent address (United News of Bangladesh, 2019)
- Framing line for handoff to Rudaba/Zobeida: the camp address itself is the gatekeeping mechanism, not just a housing shortfall, "the community finally

being let in" only happens once the address stops disqualifying people (Ghosh's own phrasing)

- ~~[confirm: insert interview clip once transcribed, covers camp-life and documentation-barrier questions from docs/01-bihari-interview-questions/questionnaire.md]~~
- Citations: Minority Rights Group International (2018); United News of Bangladesh (2019); Siddiqi (2013)

3. Connecting local to global / SDGs

3a. SDG 10, systemic inequality (Rudaba, ~2.5 min)

- SDG 10 Target 10.2: empower and promote social, economic and political inclusion of all, irrespective of status. Target 10.3: eliminate discriminatory laws, policies and practices (United Nations, 2015)
- Apply directly to what Arnab just showed: passport rejections, employment discrimination, no bank accounts, insecure land tenure are the "practice" that outlives the 2008 "law"
- Agnew's territorial trap: treating this as a settled domestic/legal matter misses that state-bound, territorial thinking is exactly what keeps a legally recognized citizen practically excluded, which is why this is a global-citizenship issue and not a domestic footnote
- Optional if time allows: exclusionary nationality policy has precedent elsewhere (Lake & Reynolds, 2008), useful comparative note, not essential
- Citations: United Nations (2015, SDG 10 targets); Agnew (1994); Hussain (2009); Minority Rights Group International (2018)

3b. SDG 6, water and welfare access (Zobeida, ~2.5 min)

- SDG 6 Target 6.1: universal, equitable access to safe and affordable drinking water for all (United Nations, 2015)
- Ground in the camp-level interview evidence: a single hand pump installed in 1971 remains the sole water source for the camp, breaks down often, repair costs outstrip what the camp committee can afford (Shahid, personal communication, August 29, 2026)
- Same pattern as Rudaba's point, restated at the level of basic services: decades-old "temporary" infrastructure left un-upgraded is systemic exclusion, not bad luck
- ~~[confirm: resident count served by this pump, one source says approximately 2,200, another says approximately 22,000]~~

- Citations: United Nations (2015, SDG 6 target); Shahid (personal communication, August 29, 2026)

4. Analysis (Affan, ~5.5 to 6 min)

- Brubaker's citizenship as social closure: states use ascription and naturalization to decide who belongs. The 1972 Citizenship Order is exactly this closure, it left Biharis with no ascribed citizenship anywhere, not Bangladesh, not Pakistan
- Distinguish formal/passive status from active citizenship: 2008 granted ID cards and voting rights, not equal access to jobs, passports, or bank accounts, the same gap Arnab and Rudaba just documented
- Agamben's camp as space of exception: apply directly to the camps Arnab described, residents "officially dead," protected by neither ordinary Bangladeshi law before 2008 nor by international refugee law (UNHCR refused refugee status since no border was crossed). The camp is bare life made material, and it outlasts the legal fix
- Arendt's "right to have rights": before 2008 the deeper deprivation was not any single denied right but the absence of a political community willing to guarantee rights at all. Explains why the post-2008 documentation gaps still matter, partial recognition still falls short of the right to have rights being fully secured in practice
- Balibar's constituted versus constituent power: the 2001 petition and the 2003/2008 rulings were insurgent citizenship, forced through by decades of organizing (Stranded Pakistanis General Repatriation Committee), not a gift from the state. Sets up the Legal Aid Desk next as continuing that same constituent-power tradition
- Reminder for scripting: every claim needs an in-text citation here, this section is graded explicitly on correct use of assigned readings
- Citations: Brubaker (1992); Agamben (2000); Arendt (1968); Balibar (2015)

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5. Feasible action, Legal Aid & Welfare Access Desk (Zobeida leads, with Rudaba, ~5.5 to 6 min)

Description:

- BRAC University law students staff a recurring desk, on-site at or near the camp, offering three services
- (1) Documentation and legal casework: NID, passport, and birth-registration help, and formally disputing camp-address-based rejections like the one Arnab cited
- (2) Welfare and infrastructure navigation: helping residents apply to existing government welfare schemes and infrastructure programs, including water/sanitation repair or upgrade requests, this is the direct SDG 6 link
- (3) Legal-literacy and awareness sessions: explaining the rights the community already won in 2008 and how to actually claim them
- Isin's activist citizen (L15-1): the law students act as engaged, activist citizens, and the desk itself is a small act of citizenship
- Keck & Sikkink's transnational advocacy networks (L15-2): the desk can plug into existing networks (established legal-aid organizations, NGOs already cited in this project such as MRG) for funding, legitimacy, and referral pathways
- Held's changing contours of political community (L13-1): justifies why a small, local, student-run action is a legitimate global-citizenship intervention and not just charity

Feasibility:

- Cost: low, volunteer law students, minimal overhead (transport, printing, maybe a small stipend), no construction spend required from the desk itself
- Who runs it: a BRAC University law student society or legal-aid clinic, coordinated with the camp committee, the same committee already organizing water-pump repairs per the Shahid interview
- Realistic obstacles: student volunteers are not licensed lawyers and need faculty or practicing-lawyer supervision for real casework, trust-building with the community takes time, sustaining the desk beyond one semester needs a handoff plan
- ~~[confirm: whether an existing legal-aid body such as BLAST is a realistic supervising partner, verify before the final script]~~

Impact:

- Every successful documentation case removes one concrete instance of the passport-office/camp-address barrier Arnab described
- Awareness sessions extend the reach of the 2008 ruling from "on paper" to "known and claimed"
- Welfare/infrastructure referrals give the community a channel to escalate problems like the 1971 hand pump beyond the camp committee's own limited resources
- Citations: Isin (2009); Keck & Sikkink (1999); Held (1999); Minority Rights Group International (2018)

6.

Reference

- Agamben, G. (2000). *Means without end: Notes on politics* (V. Binetti & C. Casarino, Trans.). University of Minnesota Press.
- Agnew, J. (1994). The territorial trap: The geographical assumptions of international relations theory. *Review of International Political Economy*, 1(1), 53-80.
- Anderson, B. (1983). *Imagined communities: Reflections on the origin and spread of nationalism*. Verso.
- Arendt, H. (1968). The decline of the nation-state and the end of the rights of man. In *The origins of totalitarianism* (pp. 267-302). Harcourt.
- Balibar, E. (2015). *Citizenship*. Polity Press.
- Held, D. (1999). The changing contours of political community: Rethinking democracy in the context of globalisation. *Theoria: A Journal of Social and Political Theory*, (94), 30-47.
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- Keck, M. E., & Sikkink, K. (1999). Transnational advocacy networks in international and regional politics. *International Social Science Journal*, 51(159), 89-101.
- Lake, M., & Reynolds, H. (2008). *Drawing the global colour line: White men's countries and the international challenge of racial equality*. Cambridge University Press.
- Linklater, A. (2002). Cosmopolitan citizenship. In E. F. Isin & B. S. Turner (Eds.), *Handbook of citizenship studies* (pp. 317-332). Sage Publications.

Minority Rights Group International. (2018). Biharis in Bangladesh.

<https://minorityrights.org/communities/biharis/>

Nussbaum, M. C. (1994). Patriotism and cosmopolitanism. Boston Review.

Siddiqi, D. M. (2013). Left behind by the nation: 'Stranded Pakistanis' in Bangladesh. Sites: New Series, 10(1), 150-183.

United Nations. (2015). Transforming our world: The 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development (A/RES/70/1). <https://sdgs.un.org/2030agenda>

United News of Bangladesh. (2019, September 21). How are the Biharis of Mirpur? The Business Standard. <https://www.tbsnews.net/bangladesh/how-are-biharis-mirpur-12929>

Personal communication: Shahid, M. (2026, August 29). Camp Incharge, Rraif Camp, Mohammadpur, Dhaka.

Note for Affan & Tahsin: some homeworks cite SDG target pages as United Nations (2015) (the 2030 Agenda document), others cite the individual goal webpage as United Nations (n.d.). Pick one style and apply it across the whole script.

Open items to confirm at today's meeting

- ~~Date conflict: the assignment brief's header lists this outline meeting as Sept 1, the point-breakdown table implies Sept 6. Confirm which is correct with the instructor if not already resolved.~~
- ~~[confirm: insert interview clip once transcribed, covers camp life and documentation barrier questions] (Section 2)~~
- ~~[confirm: resident count served by the camp's hand pump, approximately 2,200 vs. approximately 22,000 in two different drafts] (Section 3b)~~
- ~~[confirm: whether an existing legal aid body such as BLAST is a realistic supervising partner for the Legal Aid Desk] (Section 5)~~
- ~~Linklater (2002) was originally assigned to Arnab's community section in [Workplan.md](#), but its actual content (defending cosmopolitan citizenship against~~

~~Walzer's bounded-community critique) fits Tahsin's Introduction better, placed there above. Only the first two pages were checked, confirm the rest of the chapter doesn't change this before finalizing.~~

- ~~• Confirm SDG 4 is fully dropped from the group's direction for everyone, including anything Zobeida may already have prepared under the old framing.~~
- ~~• Time estimates above (3.5 / 5 / 2.5 / 2.5 / 6 / 6 min) are weighted by each section's **video** rubric points (5/7/7/7/8/8 out of 40), not the script rubric points, since the brief requires roughly equal on-camera time; adjust if the group wants a different split, but keep Analysis and Feasible Action roughly matched since they're tied for the highest video weight.~~